

Week 1 Argument Lab

What Follows From What?

Name: _____

Date: _____

Purpose

Whately says logic studies reasoning. Today you will practice finding the structure of an argument: the conclusion, the stated reason, the hidden assumption, and the question of whether the conclusion actually follows.

Part I: The Argument Skeleton

For each argument, identify the parts.

Example

Argument: "This rule is popular with most students, so it must be fair."

- **Conclusion:** The rule must be fair.
- **Stated reason:** Most students like it.
- **Hidden assumption:** Whatever most students like is fair.
- **Test:** The conclusion does not necessarily follow. Popularity and fairness are not the same thing.

1. Argument

"Macbeth hears the witches predict his future, so he cannot be responsible for what he does afterward."

Conclusion:

Stated reason:

Hidden assumption:

Does the conclusion follow? Why or why not?

2. Argument

"A person can speak confidently and still be wrong; therefore confidence is not the same thing as proof."

Conclusion:

Stated reason:

Hidden assumption:

Does the conclusion follow? Why or why not?

3. Argument

"This idea is old, so it has nothing to teach modern students."

Conclusion:

Stated reason:

Hidden assumption:

Does the conclusion follow? Why or why not?

Part II: Window Notes

Create a window note for Whately's claim that logic is useful but limited. Your window note must include:

1. A drawing or visual symbol for what logic *can* do.
2. A drawing or visual symbol for what logic *cannot* do.
3. One key sentence from the reading.
4. A 2–3 sentence explanation of your drawing.

Part III: Exit Claim

Complete this claim in one strong paragraph:

Logic is most like _____ because _____.